Zifan Zeng

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Platform algorithms and the visibility of labour and identity; recommendation systems; platform governance, including Chinese platforms; gender and digital media; critical digital methods.

EDUCATION

University of Leeds — BA (Hons) Digital Media — Sep 2024 – Jun 2027 (expected)

School of Media and Communication

- Year averages: Year 1: 69; Year 2: 72
- Selected modules (mark): Digital Communications Across Cultures (86); Introduction to Media and Communication Theory (86); Communication Research Methods (79); Interface Design (77); Programming for Digital Media (75); Working in Digital Media Teams (75)

RESEARCH OUTPUTS AND PRESENTATIONS

- **Oral presentation:** "Algorithmic Paralysis: Rethinking Choice and Discovery on Streaming Platforms." ICUR 2026.
- **Abstract under review:** "Authority Without Authorship: How AI-Product Marketing Erases the Human Judgment It Depends On." WorldCUR 2027; decision due 31 Oct 2026.
- **Publication:** 'From Event to Condition: The Collapse of the Stage in Media History.' Leeds History Student Times, Vol. 2 (2025/26), pp. 42–43.

RESEARCH AND DIGITAL PROJECTS

- **Digital Mirror** (86): coded a research website analysing cross-platform identity and platform norms through observation logs; co-produced a podcast.
- **Canal+ Asian (75):** led a team designing a streaming platform that replaces algorithmic recommendation with audience-led discovery; ran user testing and built the front end. Basis of the ICUR paper.
- **Digital methods (75):** scraped BBC news headlines via RSS to test regional agenda-setting bias; built a MySQL/PHP data-visualisation site.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI Content Growth Intern, 01Agent (Hyperspace Technology) — Jul – Aug 2026

- Planned Xiaohongshu and Bilibili content strategy for an AI content-creation platform; this inside view informed the WorldCUR study.

Junior journalist, Hunan Art and Science College — 2022 – 2023

- Three news reports published in Red Net, New Hunan and Sanxiang Metropolitan Daily.

SKILLS

- **Technical:** HTML/CSS/JavaScript, PHP/MySQL, Python web scraping (BeautifulSoup, RSS), Chart.js, p5.js, WordPress; Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects; Zotero
- **Languages:** Mandarin (native); English (fluent); Spanish (beginner)